Christian living

Purpose: *To explore the topic of adornment and to find out how much is too much.*

Centred on: *Jewellery and other associated material.*

In your opinion, is the use of jewellery inherently a sin?

Revelation 4: 4, 10… Here we find ornamentation. If the wearing of ornaments/jewellery is inherently sinful then God would not allow this in heaven.

Now, do think that the unlimited use of jewellery and adornment is consistent with the character of Christ whilst He was on earth? Of course not, so we must ask ourselves then, how much would be too much?

Ezekiel 28: 13-15… Talking about the King of Tyre using him as a figure of Satan. Here we have a creature being described who was the covering cherub (sanctuary language). The two cherubim angels were situated above the mercy seat of the Ark of the Covenant and they were positioned with outstretched wings for the purpose of shielding anyone around from the glory of God. So Satan was an angel standing in the very presence of God!

You do not wear jewellery because you think you are ugly…you wear it because you think it makes you look more attractive

If it was a danger for Lucifer who was perfect, do you think it is possible for you to fall because of the same thing?

Lucifer began to ascribe for himself that which was the glory of God.

Critical thinking: The Bible says in **1 John 1: 5**…"God is light, in Him is no darkness," So we have an anointing cherub that is covered with a vast array of precious stones standing before God whom is light! Consider what this would look like. This is perhaps why **Isaiah 14: 12,** refers to him as "the son of the morning."

Ezekiel 28: 17… "your heart was lifted up because of your beauty." Lucifer was made perfect, yet he fell because of his beauty! How were we made?

John 3: 3… By default, what is Jesus suggesting about the first birth? It is not good enough!

Psalm 51: 5… Born in sin.

Critical thinking: If a perfect being could become proud because of his beauty, which we know was accentuated by his jewellery, could the use of jewellery present a danger to a fallen, sinful creature?

IF A BEING WHO WAS CREATED PERFECT FELL BECAUSE OF HIS BEAUTY, COULD YOU FALL BECAUSE OF THE SAME THING?

Let's look at some issues in the Bible where jewellery was concerned…

Genesis 35: 1-2… Note the three requests that Jacob stipulates to his household prior to their presentation before God.

Genesis 35: 3-4… Here is suggested that the people were wearing jewellery and that they felt it was important to remove it as they went before God.

~ WHAT DOES THIS PASSAGE SHOW US JEWELRY CAN BECOME?

~ WHAT CALIBRE OF FAMILY IS THIS

~ IF THEY COULD BEGIN TO IDOLISE THEIR JEWELRY COULD IT POSSIBLY HAPPEN TO US?

Jacob understands that his family have a lot of idols in their midst, so he wanted to make sure that they removed all these things before going before God.

Their jewellery was included in the whole act of idol worship.

These weren't statue-laden jewellery, but rather their jewellery had become an idol to them, so they removed it and gave it to Jacob alongside their statues.

Idol worship we know is wrong…

THIS IS AN EXTRAORDNARY FAMILY RIGHT? FATHER WRESTELD WITH GOD, SPOKE WITH GOD ETC

If this extraordinary family was subject to allowing jewellery to become an idol in their lives, do you think it is a possibility for this same thing to become an idol and a problem for us too?

Exodus 33: 1-6…God is declaring that his people are "stiff-necked." With this revelation, the people then removed their ornaments. Is it possible that their Jewellery led them to pride?

~ WHY IN VS3 IS GOD UNABLE TO COME INTO THE MIDST OF HIS PEOPLE?

~ WHAT DOES GOD COMMAND THE PEOPLE TO DO IN ORDER TO REMEDY THEIR PRIDE?

~ IF JEWELLERY CONTRIBUTED TO THEIR PRIDE COULD IT CONTRIBUTE TO OURS TOO?

~ DID THE NT AUTHORS UNDERSTAND THIS?

WHY WOULD GOD SAY TAKE OFF YOUR JEWELRY IF IT DID NOT CONTRIBUTE TO THEIR PRIDE

The reason their jewels were referenced was because they contributed to the issue that was causing God to be close to destroying them. They were in danger because of their pride.

WHERE THEY AN ORDINARY SET OF PEOPLE OR EXTRAORDINARY?

They walked through the Red sea, were fed from heaven, and drank water from the rock, heard Gods actual voice speaking from Mount Horeb. They had an extraordinary experience more so than us.

IS PRIDE A SIN?

Yes

Do you think the NT authors were aware of this problem too?

1 Peter 3: 1-4…According to Peter, the focus of adornment should be putting on beautiful things inside of our hearts. Peter is not promoting that it is a ten commandment rule, but rather he recognises the potential danger that adornment presents to the carnal mind.

Jewellery is not a sin…but we have learnt that it can lead to sin (pride, idolatry)

Hebrews 12: 1…

~ HAVE WE SEEN FROM THIS STUDY THAT JEWELRY CAN WEIGH YOU DOWN?

~ DO YOU BELIEVE GOD LOVES

~ SO WHAT DOES THE BIBLE SAY YOU NEED TO DO WITH YOUR JEWELRY?

Everything that weighs you down is not sinful but the Bible says we should lay it aside. The Bible has shown that the jewellery of His people was weighing them down so He counsels us to lay these things aside. We need to lay aside not only the sin but also the things that can weigh us down.

~ IS IT FAIR TO SAY THAT THIS IS NOT JUST ISOLATED TO JEWELRY; IT COULD BE MUSIC, FOOD ETC?

Jewellery leads to our natural tendency to be proud…lay it aside.

Temperance in all things, humble in all things.
We as a family have decided not to wear jewellery so that at all costs we can protect our mission. We have taken measures to protect ourselves from the things that God has shown His people to struggle with.

Not wrong to run a 400m race with a backpack on
It just isn't wise because it slows you down.

APPEAL:

John 19: 23-24…If anyone could have worn jewellery, it was Jesus but the soldiers didn't cast lots for his jewellery.

I don't wear jewellery because Jesus didn't wear jewellery and I believe He is our example. He was modest and simple and didn't wear anything that was not essential.